

EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-In Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Dashboard Insights, Conditional Formatting, and Kanban Analytics for the Loan Management System

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Aim

To explore the AI-assisted and built-in analytics capabilities of Zoho Creator, powered by Zia, Zoho's AI assistant, by reviewing a dashboard, conditionally formatted reports and Kanban-grouped views of the Loan Management System, and to understand how these features turn raw form data into actionable visual insight without writing custom code.

Objectives

- To review the application dashboard's summary tiles and charts (Distribution by Loan Status, Distribution by Created By).
- To study how conditional formatting highlights Loan Status and Payment Status values with colour so patterns are visible at a glance.
- To study Kanban report views (Loan Status, Loan Types) as a built-in way to group and visualise records without any scripting.
- To review the All Loan Types list report as the structured reference data these analytics are built on.
- To understand Zia's role within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, generating dashboard layouts, and surfacing patterns in application data.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Loan Management System application
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode

Introduction / Theory

Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator ships with analytics components that turn form records into visual summaries without any separate BI tool. A Dashboard page can combine summary tiles, pie and bar charts, and embedded reports in one view; individual reports can use conditional formatting to colour rows or cells by field value; and a Kanban report groups records into columns by a chosen field, giving a board-style view of status or category. All of these read live data directly from the application's forms, so the visuals update automatically as records are added or changed.

Zia - Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, including Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features assist application builders by suggesting appropriate chart types for a given report, helping auto-generate dashboard layouts from existing forms, and surfacing trends (such as which loan status or loan type occurs most often) that would otherwise need manual analysis. Rather than requiring the developer to hand-code every chart, Zia-assisted suggestions speed up the process of turning a plain data table into a meaningful visual summary.

Key Concepts

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page combining summary tiles, charts, and embedded reports into a single, auto-refreshing overview of application data.
Chart Widget	A visual element (pie, bar, donut, etc.) bound to a report that summarises records by a chosen field, such as Loan Status or Created By.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that colours a cell or row automatically based on its value, making outliers (e.g. Rejected applications, Overdue repayments) stand out without manual review.

Concept	Description
Kanban Report	A board-style report that groups records into columns by a selected field (e.g. Loan Status, Loan Type), letting staff scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts, and highlight patterns in the underlying data.

Application Specifications

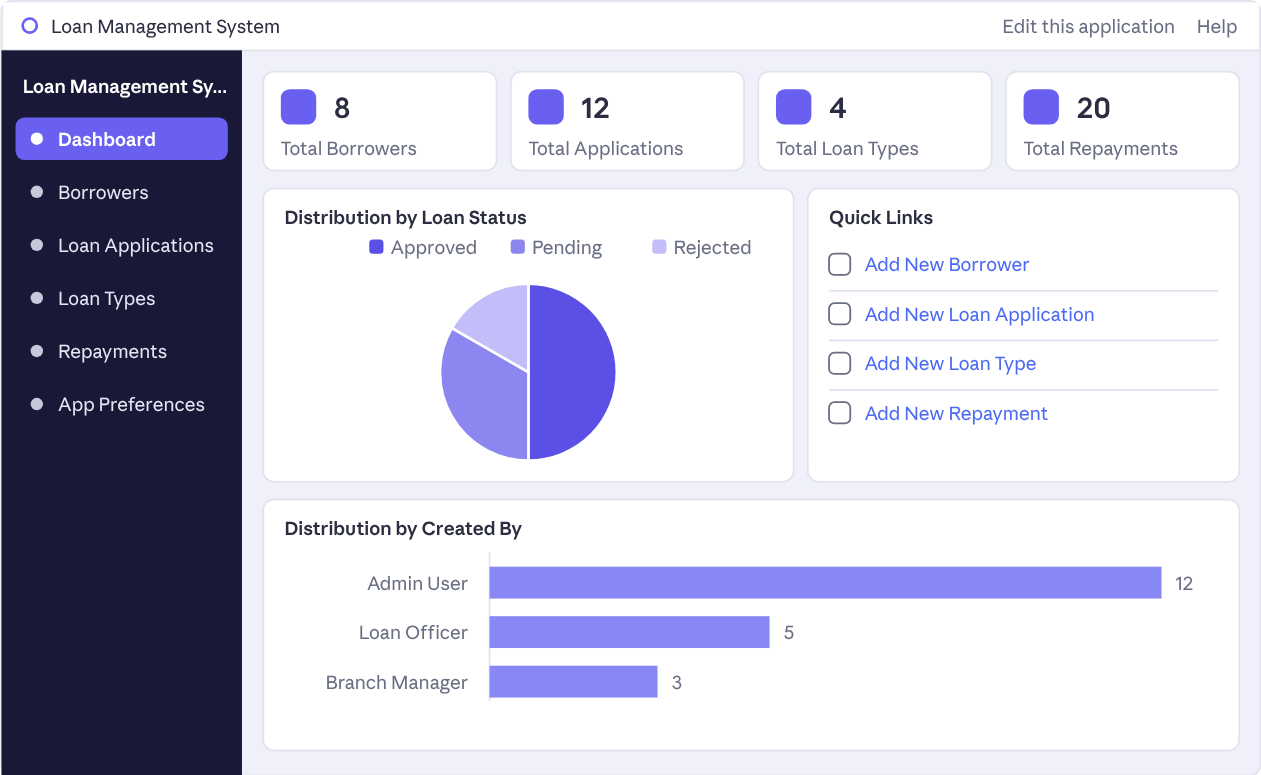
Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Loan Management System
Primary Forms	Borrower, Loan Application, Loan Type, Repayment
Dashboard Elements	Total Borrowers, Total Loan Applications, Total Loan Types, Total Repayments tiles; Distribution by Loan Status pie chart; Quick Links; Distribution by Created By bar chart
Conditionally Formatted Reports	All Loan Applications (coloured by Status), All Repayments (coloured by Payment Status)
Kanban Reports	Loan Status (grouped by Pending, Approved, Rejected, Closed), Loan Types (grouped by Loan Type under Loan Applications)
Master Data Report	All Loan Types: Loan Type Name, Code, Interest Rate, Maximum Amount, Tenure, Is Active

Procedure

The figures in this record are illustrative representations drawn with sample values; they are not screenshots of the application.

1. Open the application dashboard - Opening the Loan Management System loads its Dashboard, which summarises the forms into tiles and charts as soon as records exist.

One dashboard summarises borrowers, applications and repayments



Dashboard · tiles, pie chart, bar chart (sample values)

Figure 9.1: Dashboard - Summary Tiles and Charts (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

The dashboard shows four count tiles (Borrowers, Loan Applications, Loan Types, Repayments), a Distribution by Loan Status pie chart, Quick Links shortcuts, and a Distribution by Created By bar chart, all generated directly from form data with no manual charting.

2. Inspect the conditionally formatted loan-application report - The All Loan Applications report is opened to see how its Status column is colour-coded automatically.

Status colours show which applications are approved, pending or rejected

Loan Management System

Edit this application Help

Loan Management Sy...

Dashboard

Loan Applications

+ Loan Application

All Loan Applications

Loan Status

Loan Types

Repayments

+ Repayment

All Repayments

Borrowers

Loan Types

+ Loan Type

All Loan Types

App Preferences

All Loan Applications

+

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Applicant	Loan Type	Amount (INR)	Status	Applied On
Borrower 1	Personal Loan	150,000	Approved	05-Oct-2026
Borrower 2	Vehicle Loan	600,000	Pending	05-Oct-2026
Borrower 3	Home Loan	2,500,000	Rejected	05-Oct-2026
Borrower 4	Education Loan	400,000	Approved	05-Oct-2026
Borrower 5	Personal Loan	100,000	Pending	05-Oct-2026

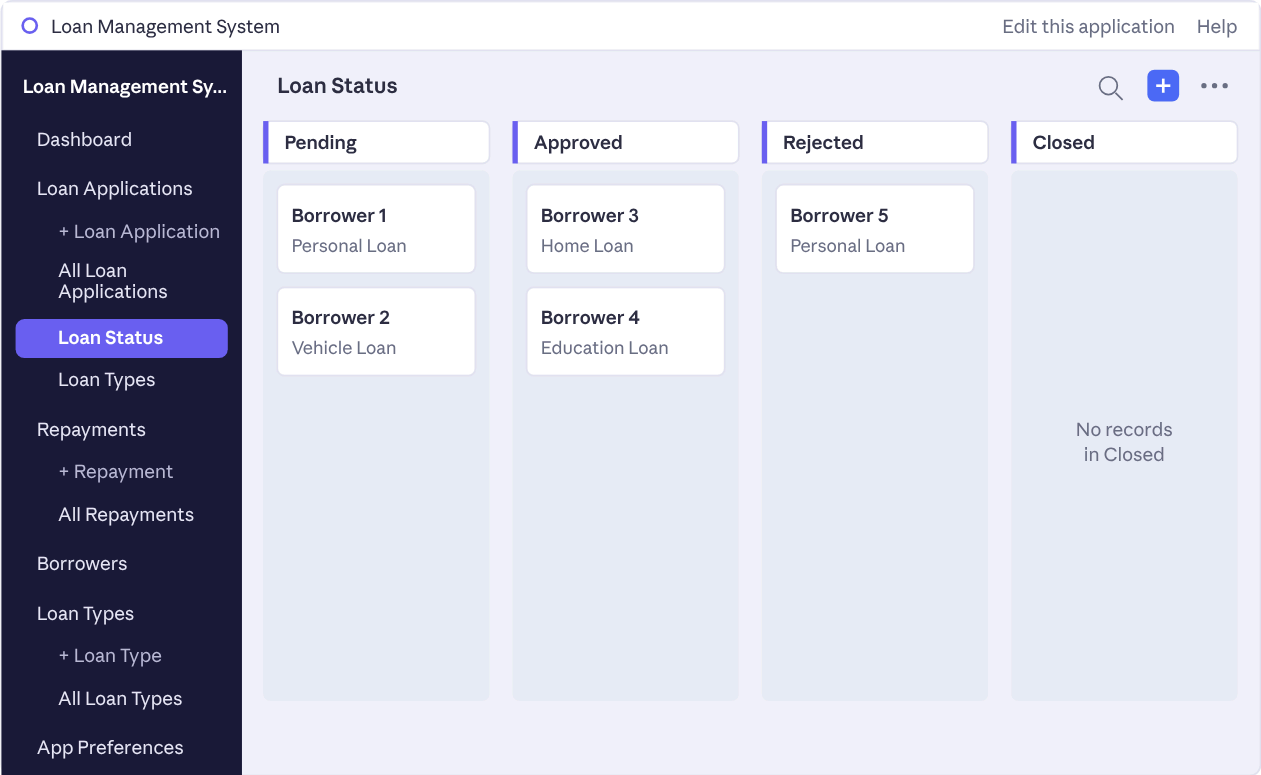
All Loan Applications · Status colours (sample values)

Figure 9.2: All Loan Applications - Conditional Formatting by Status (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

Each row's Status cell is shaded by value, green for Approved, blue for Pending and red for Rejected, so a reviewer can scan the whole report and spot applications that need attention immediately rather than reading every row.

3. Switch to the Loan Status Kanban view - A Kanban report named Loan Status groups the loan-application records into columns by their Status field.

Applications are grouped into four status columns; Closed is empty



Loan Status Kanban · 4 columns (sample values)

Figure 9.3: Loan Status - Kanban Report (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

The board shows four columns (Pending, Approved, Rejected, Closed) with each record rendered as a card under the borrower's name and a short note; a column with no records states this explicitly instead of leaving the column ambiguous.

4. Review the repayment-status report - The All Repayments report is opened next, where the Payment Status column uses the same conditional-colouring approach.

Payment Status colours flag paid, due and overdue instalments

Loan Management System

Edit this applicationHelp

Loan Management Sy...

Dashboard

Loan Applications

+ Loan Application

All Loan Applications

Loan Status

Loan Types

Repayments

+ Repayment

All Repayments

Borrowers

Loan Types

+ Loan Type

All Loan Types

App Preferences

All Repayments

+

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Borrower	Due Date	EMI Amount (INR)	Payment Status	Paid On
Borrower 1	05-Aug-2026	12,500	Paid	04-Aug-2026
Borrower 2	05-Sep-2026	8,200	Paid	05-Sep-2026
Borrower 3	05-Sep-2026	15,000	Overdue	-
Borrower 4	05-Nov-2026	6,400	Due	-
Borrower 5	05-Nov-2026	9,800	Due	-

All Repayments · Payment Status colours (sample values)

Figure 9.4: All Repayments - Conditional Formatting by Payment Status (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

Payment Status values are colour-coded (green for Paid, blue for Due, red for Overdue), letting the collections team see at a glance which instalments still need action.

5. Review the underlying master data - The All Loan Types report is opened to confirm the structured reference data (loan type codes, interest rates, limits, tenure) that other analytics and lookups draw on.

Each loan type carries its own code, rate, limit and tenure

Loan Management System

Edit this applicationHelp

Loan Management Sy...

Dashboard

Loan Applications

+ Loan Application

All Loan Applications

Loan Status

Loan Types

Repayments

+ Repayment

All Repayments

Borrowers

Loan Types

+ Loan Type

All Loan Types

App Preferences

All Loan Types

+

...

Loan Type	Code	Interest Rate (%)	Max Amount (INR)	Tenure (months)	Is Active
Personal Loan	LT-PERS	11.5	500,000	60	true
Home Loan	LT-HOME	8.5	5,000,000	240	true
Education Loan	LT-EDU	9.0	1,000,000	120	true
Vehicle Loan	LT-VEH	9.5	800,000	84	true

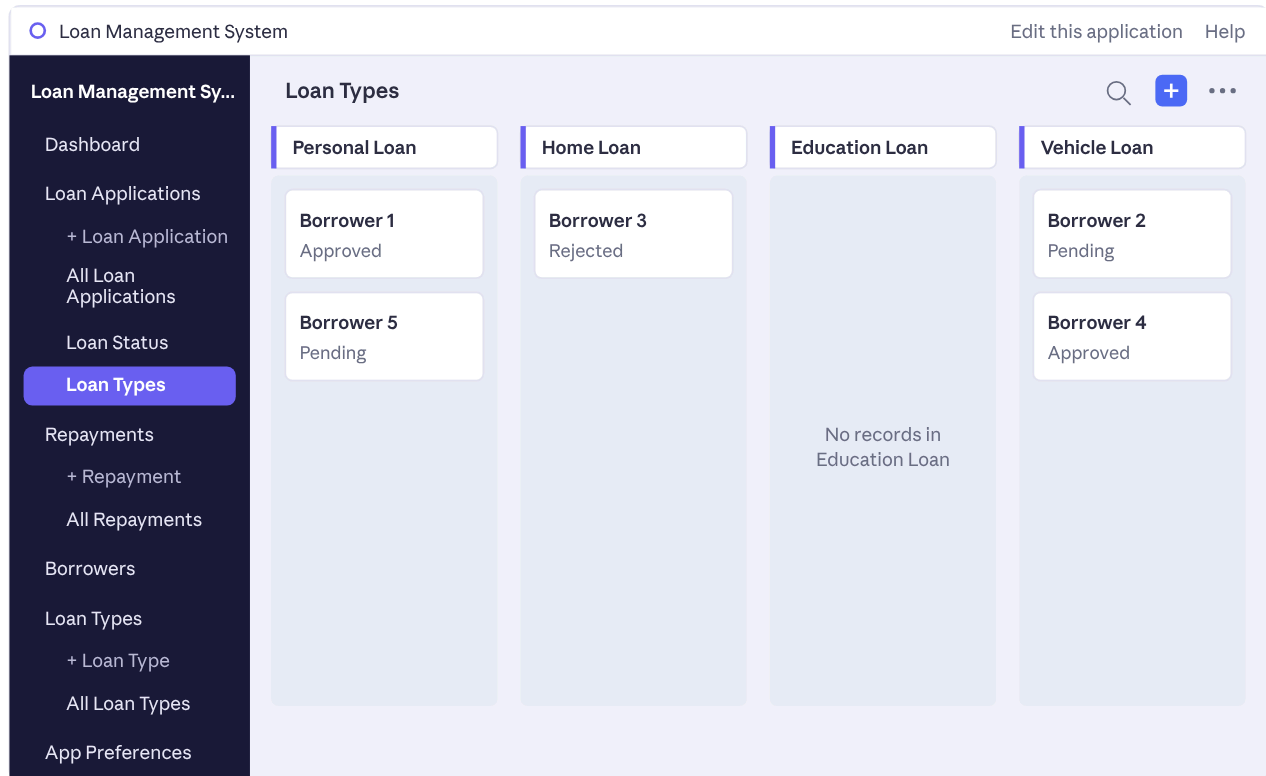
All Loan Types · master data (sample values)

Figure 9.5: All Loan Types - Structured Reference Data (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

Each loan type is listed with its code, interest rate, maximum amount, tenure and active status, forming the clean reference data that the dashboard and Kanban views ultimately summarise.

6. Explore the Loan Types Kanban view - Finally, a second Kanban report, Loan Types, is opened to see loan applications grouped visually by the type of loan.

Applications are grouped by loan type; Education has none



Loan Types Kanban · grouped by loan type (sample values)

Figure 9.6: Loan Types - Kanban Report Grouped by Loan Type (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

Application cards are grouped into columns such as Personal, Home, Education and Vehicle; empty columns are labelled "No records" rather than left blank, keeping the board readable even with sparse data.

Result

- The Loan Management System's dashboard was reviewed, confirming that it summarises the forms into live tiles and charts without manual configuration.
- Conditional formatting was observed on two reports, All Loan Applications (by Status) and All Repayments (by Payment Status), both colouring values automatically to highlight patterns.
- Two Kanban report views, Loan Status and Loan Types, were reviewed, confirming records can be grouped and browsed visually by any chosen field.

- The All Loan Types report was reviewed as the structured reference data underlying these analytics.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated how Zoho Creator's built-in analytics and Zia-assisted features convert plain form records into decision-ready visuals with no custom charting code. The dashboard's tiles and charts give an instant overview of volume and distribution, conditional formatting turns a flat table into a scannable status map, and Kanban reports let staff browse the same data as a visual board grouped by whatever field matters most: loan status, payment status, or loan type. Together these features show that low-code analytics in Zoho Creator is not an afterthought bolted onto the application, but a natural extension of the same structured forms and reports already built in earlier experiments.